

# Start with a Plan - Checklist

The first months in a leadership role are critical for shaping your organization's future. Use this checklist to focus on three key areas:

## First 90 Days

- ☐ Identify immediate priorities and build strong stakeholder relationships.
- ☐ Meet with key community leaders, business owners, and board members to align expectations.
- ☐ Establish short-term action items and milestones to create early momentum.
- ☐ Review existing strategic plans and assess alignment with community needs.

## Sustainable Growth

- ☐ Develop systems for funding, volunteer engagement, and board development.
- ☐ Create a volunteer recruitment and retention strategy.
- ☐ Diversify revenue streams by identifying new funding sources, including grants and sponsorships.
- ☐ Strengthen board governance by defining roles, expectations, and leadership succession plans.

## Ongoing Evaluation

- ☐ Track progress and adjust strategies based on community needs.
- ☐ Implement a system for gathering feedback from stakeholders.
- ☐ Regularly review financial health and program effectiveness.
- ☐ Set benchmarks for success and adapt plans based on measurable outcomes.

By focusing on these areas, you'll create a strong foundation that supports long-term impact. A well-structured plan ensures that your organization remains adaptable, financially sustainable, and aligned with community needs. Taking intentional steps in these early stages will help build lasting relationships, strengthen engagement, and set your Main Street program up for continued success.